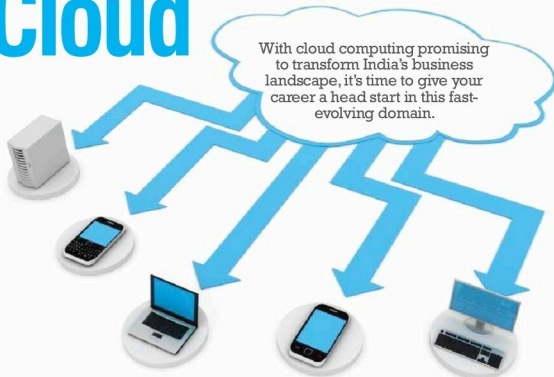


A Career in the Cloud



Refashioning their conventional business models, enterprises both big and small, are increasingly embracing cloud-based solutions to accelerate their business' growth, cost-effectively. No wonder, the fast-evolving domain of cloud computing is opening up new vistas in the employment market. If a study by Microsoft is anything to go by, cloud computing will create some 14 million new jobs across the globe by 2015, and India alone will generate over 2 million. As the trend of cloud computing sweeps across India, building a career in this area can be a good decision.

Why cloud computing is hot in India

"Cloud computing is all set to revolutionise the Indian IT job market. The need for new talent to help these companies take on cloud technology will grow, thus pushing the demand for cloud experts in the next two years. People are gradually waking up to its potential and getting themselves enrolled in training institutes for a course in cloud computing. The curriculum in cloud computing generally deals with the basics, cloud computing mechanisms, cloud security threats and ways to combat it, and more," quips Niraj Agrawal, director, Mindscripts Technologies Training Solutions, Pune.

Of emerging roles and the required skillsets

Cloud computing is not only changing the business dynamics of the globe, but also altering the nature of jobs. In the process, new roles in the cloud domain are slowly making their presence felt, says Venkat Ramavath, director, Data Point Infotech, Bengaluru. "Interesting roles like that of a cloud architect, cloud security specialist, cloud developer, etc, are emerging in this terrain. A cloud architect will work in sync with the requirements of the client, delivering and managing the cloud infrastructure for them. A cloud security specialist will need to understand the security models and ensure the safety of the business' data in the cloud. A cloud developer designs applications and deploys them on various platforms," says Ramavath. The emerging roles in cloud computing also call for redefined skillsets, says Kunal Kumar, cloud computing specialist and VMware-certified professional. "The need for a strong foundation in programming languages, like Java.net, C++, etc, and a basic understanding of product development and software application remains the same. But IT professionals must now upgrade their skills to also focus on business development and consumer-oriented requirements, as this will help the companies improve their cash flows," elaborates Kunal.